LABOUR SOCIAL SECURITY, UNORGANISED AND GIG WORKERS

STATUS LADDER → THREE STATUTORY CATEGORIES → CONTRIBUTION FRAMEWORK CARD → REGISTRATION TO BENEFIT → DELIVERY INSTITUTIONS → SCALE ANCHOR CARD

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure: the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

◆ PRIMARY CORE FLOW ◆ SUBORDINATE EXTRA ◆ APPROVAL / REVIEW

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • source generation g3 and all prior artifacts unchanged

00 STATUS LADDER

STATUS LADDER · RUNG 1 · THE CODE ON SOCIAL SECURITY, 2020 IS PASSED · RUNG 2 · BROUGHT INTO FORCE ON 21 NOVEMBER 2025 · RUNG 3 · RULES AND SCHEME · FINAL CENTRAL RULES NOTIFIED IN MAY 2026; STATE RULES

RUNG 1 → enacted: the Code on Social Security, 2020 is passed

RUNG 2 → commenced: brought into force on 21 November 2025 → RUNG 3 → rules and scheme: final Central Rules notified in May 2026; State rules → RUNG 4 → collected: a notified rate and an administered contribution ledger

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
• RUNG 1 → enacted: the Code on Social Security, 2020 is passed • RUNG 2 → commenced: brought into force on 21 November 2025	• RUNG 3 → rules and scheme: final Central Rules notified in May 2026; State rules pending relevance • RUNG 4 → collected: a notified rate and an administered contribution ledger	• RUNG 5 → delivered: registration, claims rules, grievance redress and a benefit received • MUST REMEMBER: Labour social security must cover lifecycle and work-related risks across…

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: MUST REMEMBER: Labour social security must cover lifecycle and work-related risks across.

01 THREE STATUTORY CATEGORIES

THREE STATUTORY CATEGORIES · GIG WORKER · EARNS FROM WORK OUTSIDE A TRADITIONAL EMPLOYER-EMPLOYEE RELATIONSHIP · PLATFORM WORKER · WORKS OUTSIDE THAT RELATIONSHIP THROUGH AN ONLINE PLATFORM FOR · DIGITAL INTERMEDIARY OR MARKETPLACE CONNECTING USER AND PROVIDER · THE FIRST TWO ARE WORKER CATEGORIES; THE THIRD IS · A DEFINITION CREATES ELIGIBILITY TO BE COVERED, NOT A

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
GIG WORKER → earns from work outside a traditional employer-employee relationship PLATFORM WORKER → works outside that relationship through an online platform for payment	AGGREGATOR → digital intermediary or marketplace connecting user and provider ROLE → the first two are worker categories; the third is the financing node	LIMIT → a definition creates eligibility to be covered, not a benefit GIG WORKER → earns from work outside a traditional employer-employee relationship

CORE CLAIM
- GIG WORKER → earns from work outside a traditional employer-employee relationship
- PLATFORM WORKER → works outside that relationship through an online platform for payment

MECHANISM
- AGGREGATOR → digital intermediary or marketplace connecting user and provider
- ROLE → the first two are worker categories; the third is the financing node

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- LIMIT → a definition creates eligibility to be covered, not a benefit
- GIG WORKER → earns from work outside a traditional employer-employee relationship

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: LIMIT → a definition creates eligibility to be covered, not a benefit.

02 CONTRIBUTION FRAMEWORK CARD

CONTRIBUTION FRAMEWORK CARD · SECTION 114 OF THE CODE ON SOCIAL SECURITY, 2020 · RATE FLOOR · AT LEAST ONE PER CENT OF AN AGGREGATOR'S ANNUAL · RATE CEILING · NOT MORE THAN TWO PER CENT OF THAT ANNUAL · PAYOUT CAP · FIVE PER CENT OF AMOUNTS PAID OR PAYABLE TO

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
PROVISION → Section 114 of the Code on Social Security, 2020 RATE FLOOR → at least one per cent of an aggregator's annual turnover	RATE CEILING → not more than two per cent of that annual turnover PAYOUT CAP → five per cent of amounts paid or payable to gig and platform workers	STATUS → a framework for a notified rate; not proof of a collected levy PROVISION → Section 114 of the Code on Social Security, 2020

CORE CLAIM
- PROVISION → Section 114 of the Code on Social Security, 2020
- RATE FLOOR → at least one per cent of an aggregator's annual turnover

MECHANISM
- RATE CEILING → not more than two per cent of that annual turnover
- PAYOUT CAP → five per cent of amounts paid or payable to gig and platform workers

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- STATUS → a framework for a notified rate; not proof of a collected levy
- PROVISION → Section 114 of the Code on Social Security, 2020

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: STATUS → a framework for a notified rate; not proof of a collected levy.

03 REGISTRATION TO BENEFIT

REGISTRATION TO BENEFIT · DATABASE ENTRY · IDENTITY RECORDED WITH A UNIVERSAL ACCOUNT NUMBER SINCE 2021 · SCHEME MATCHING · AGE, INCOME, OCCUPATION, CONTRIBUTION AND DOCUMENTATION RULES APPLY · PAYMENT FRICTION · BANK ACCESS, DOCUMENTS, AWARENESS AND DATA QUALITY CAN INTERRUPT · OUTCOME RISK

DATABASE ENTRY → identity recorded with a universal account number since 2021 → SCHEME MATCHING: age, income, occupation, contribution and documentation rules apply → PAYMENT FRICTION: bank access, documents, awareness and data quality can interrupt → OUTCOME RISK: a high registration total can coexist with low pension or insurance uptake → RULE → registration is necessary and is not sufficient

CORE CLAIM
- DATABASE ENTRY → identity recorded with a universal account number since 2021
- SCHEME MATCHING: age, income, occupation, contribution and documentation rules apply

MECHANISM
- PAYMENT FRICTION: bank access, documents, awareness and data quality can interrupt
- OUTCOME RISK: a high registration total can coexist with low pension or insurance uptake

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- RULE → registration is necessary and is not sufficient
- DATABASE ENTRY → identity recorded with a universal account number since 2021

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: RULE → registration is necessary and is not sufficient.

04 DELIVERY INSTITUTIONS

DELIVERY INSTITUTIONS · PENSION ROUTE · VOLUNTARY, CONTRIBUTORY, MATCHING CONTRIBUTIONS, SEPARATE ENROLMENT REQUIRED · PENSION VALUE · THREE THOUSAND RUPEES PER MONTH AFTER AGE SIXTY, SUBJECT · CONSTRUCTION BOARDS · STATE BOARDS UNDER THE 1996 FRAMEWORK, FUNDED BY THE · FORMAL SECTOR

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
PENSION ROUTE → voluntary, contributory, matching contributions, separate enrolment required PENSION VALUE → three thousand rupees per month after age sixty, subject to conditions	CONSTRUCTION BOARDS → State boards under the 1996 framework, funded by the welfare cess FORMAL SECTOR → provident fund and employee insurance where the applicable statutes cover	RULE → identify the owning institution before judging whether a worker is protected PENSION ROUTE → voluntary, contributory, matching contributions, separate enrolment required

CORE CLAIM
- PENSION ROUTE → voluntary, contributory, matching contributions, separate enrolment required
- PENSION VALUE → three thousand rupees per month after age sixty, subject to conditions

MECHANISM
- CONSTRUCTION BOARDS → State boards under the 1996 framework, funded by the welfare cess
- FORMAL SECTOR → provident fund and employee insurance where the applicable statutes cover

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- RULE → identify the owning institution before judging whether a worker is protected
- PENSION ROUTE → voluntary, contributory, matching contributions, separate enrolment required

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: RULE → identify the owning institution before judging whether a worker is protected.

05 SCALE ANCHOR CARD

SCALE ANCHOR CARD · A 2022 REPORT OF THE NATIONAL POLICY THINK TANK · 7.7 MILLION GIG WORKERS IN 2020-21 · 23.5 MILLION BY 2029-30 · A SCENARIO, NOT A WORKER REGISTRY OR A BENEFICIARY · BACKGROUND STATUTE · THE UNORGANISED WORKERS' SOCIAL SECURITY ACT, 2008 · CLOSE DISTINCTION

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
SOURCE → a 2022 report of the national policy think tank ESTIMATE → 7.7 million gig workers in 2020-21	PROJECTION → 23.5 million by 2029-30 STATUS → a scenario, not a worker registry or a beneficiary count	BACKGROUND STATUTE → the Unorganised Workers' Social Security Act, 2008 CLOSE DISTINCTION: Gig worker is not necessarily an employee, platform registration is…

CORE CLAIM
- SOURCE → a 2022 report of the national policy think tank
- ESTIMATE → 7.7 million gig workers in 2020-21

MECHANISM
- PROJECTION → 23.5 million by 2029-30
- STATUS → a scenario, not a worker registry or a beneficiary count

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- BACKGROUND STATUTE → the Unorganised Workers' Social Security Act, 2008
- CLOSE DISTINCTION: Gig worker is not necessarily an employee, platform registration is…

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CLOSE DISTINCTION: Gig worker is not necessarily an employee, platform registration is.

06 PLATFORM-POWER CHAIN

PLATFORM-POWER CHAIN · ALGORITHMIC CONTROL · RATINGS, INCENTIVES, TASK ALLOCATION AND DEACTIVATION · INCOME VOLATILITY · VARIABLE DEMAND AND UNILATERAL INCENTIVE CHANGES · CONTRIBUTION DIFFICULTY · IRREGULAR EARNINGS OBSTRUCT REGULAR CONTRIBUTIONS · CLASSIFICATION BOUNDARY

ALGORITHMIC CONTROL → ratings, incentives, task allocation and deactivation

INCOME VOLATILITY → variable demand and unilateral incentive changes → CONTRIBUTION DIFFICULTY → irregular earnings obstruct regular contributions → CLASSIFICATION BOUNDARY → recognition does not settle every labour-standard dispute

CORE CLAIM
- ALGORITHMIC CONTROL → ratings, incentives, task allocation and deactivation
- INCOME VOLATILITY → variable demand and unilateral incentive changes

MECHANISM
- CONTRIBUTION DIFFICULTY → irregular earnings obstruct regular contributions
- CLASSIFICATION BOUNDARY → recognition does not settle every labour-standard dispute

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- VOICE GAP → an application grievance channel is not bargaining or adjudication
- ALGORITHMIC CONTROL → ratings, incentives, task allocation and deactivation

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VOICE GAP → an application grievance channel is not bargaining or adjudication.

07 PORTABILITY TEST

PORTABILITY TEST · PORTABLE CARD · A UNIVERSAL ACCOUNT NUMBER THAT FOLLOWS THE WORKER · PORTABLE BENEFIT · CONTRIBUTION RECORDS THAT FOLLOW THE WORKER AS WELL · ALSO REQUIRED · ELIGIBILITY RULES, CLAIM SETTLEMENT AND GRIEVANCE ACROSS STATES AND · A BOARD-REGISTERED CONSTRUCTION WORKER HOLDS A BENEFIT; A DATABASE-ONLY

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
PORTABLE CARD → a universal account number that follows the worker PORTABLE BENEFIT → contribution records that follow the worker as well	ALSO REQUIRED → eligibility rules, claim settlement and grievance across States and platforms CONTRAST → a board-registered construction worker holds a benefit; a database-only worker may not	RISK → cross-platform data creates surveillance exposure needing purpose limitation and consent PORTABLE CARD → a universal account number that follows the worker

CORE CLAIM
- PORTABLE CARD → a universal account number that follows the worker
- PORTABLE BENEFIT → contribution records that follow the worker as well

MECHANISM
- ALSO REQUIRED → eligibility rules, claim settlement and grievance across States and platforms
- CONTRAST → a board-registered construction worker holds a benefit; a database-only worker may not

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- RISK → cross-platform data creates surveillance exposure needing purpose limitation and consent
- PORTABLE CARD → a universal account number that follows the worker

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: RISK → cross-platform data creates surveillance exposure needing purpose limitation and consent.

08 FINANCING MIX

FINANCING MIX · TAX-FINANCED FLOOR · REDUCES EXCLUSION OF LOW AND IRREGULAR EARNERS; HIGHER FISCAL · CONTRIBUTORY TOP-UP · DEEPENS COVER; EXCLUDES WORKERS WITH VOLATILE EARNINGS · AGGREGATOR LEVY · PLACES THE OBLIGATION ON THE PARTY WITH TURNOVER AND · THE LEVY MAY BE PASSED TO WORKERS OR USERS

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
TAX-FINANCED FLOOR → reduces exclusion of low and irregular earners; higher fiscal cost CONTRIBUTORY TOP-UP → deepens cover; excludes workers with volatile earnings	AGGREGATOR LEVY → places the obligation on the party with turnover and data INCIDENCE → the levy may be passed to workers or users; transparency and analysis needed	CONCLUSION → a credible gig model usually needs both floor and top-up TAX-FINANCED FLOOR → reduces exclusion of low and irregular earners; higher fiscal cost

CORE CLAIM
- TAX-FINANCED FLOOR → reduces exclusion of low and irregular earners; higher fiscal cost
- CONTRIBUTORY TOP-UP → deepens cover; excludes workers with volatile earnings

MECHANISM
- AGGREGATOR LEVY → places the obligation on the party with turnover and data
- INCIDENCE → the levy may be passed to workers or users; transparency and analysis needed

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- CONCLUSION → a credible gig model usually needs both floor and top-up
- TAX-FINANCED FLOOR → reduces exclusion of low and irregular earners; higher fiscal cost

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CONCLUSION → a credible gig model usually needs both floor and top-up.

09 PROHIBITED INVENTIONS

PROHIBITED INVENTIONS · NO THRESHOLD · NO NINETY-DAY OR ONE-HUNDRED-AND-TWENTY-DAY NATIONAL ELIGIBILITY RULE · NO LEVY CLAIM · NO ASSERTION OF A COLLECTED NATIONWIDE CONTRIBUTION OR FUND · NO STATUS UPGRADE · A DEFINITION DOES NOT SETTLE WAGES, HOURS, DISMISSAL OR · NO INSURANCE SHORTCUT

NO THRESHOLD → no ninety-day or one-hundred-and-twenty-day national eligibility rule → NO LEVY CLAIM → no assertion of a collected nationwide contribution or fund balance → NO STATUS UPGRADE → a definition does not settle wages, hours, dismissal or bargaining → NO INSURANCE SHORTCUT → hospitalisation cover does not correct pay or deactivation → NO KEY → no option or answer letter for the routed objective demand

CORE CLAIM
- NO THRESHOLD → no ninety-day or one-hundred-and-twenty-day national eligibility rule
- NO LEVY CLAIM → no assertion of a collected nationwide contribution or fund balance

MECHANISM
- NO STATUS UPGRADE → a definition does not settle wages, hours, dismissal or bargaining
- NO INSURANCE SHORTCUT → hospitalisation cover does not correct pay or deactivation

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- NO KEY → no option or answer letter for the routed objective demand
- NO THRESHOLD → no ninety-day or one-hundred-and-twenty-day national eligibility rule

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: NO THRESHOLD → no ninety-day or one-hundred-and-twenty-day national eligibility rule.

10 ROUTED OBJECTIVE DEMAND

ROUTED OBJECTIVE DEMAND · YEAR AND PAPER · 2024 PRELIMS GENERAL STUDIES PAPER I, QUESTION NUMBERED 100 · THE UNORGANISED-WORKER PENSION ROUTE, RENDERED NEUTRALLY IN THE AUDITED · KEY STATUS · OFFICIAL SET-A KEY AVAILABLE LOCALLY; THE ANSWER IS NOT · PACKAGE RULE · NO OPTION, KEY OR INFERRED ANSWER LETTER IS STATED

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
YEAR AND PAPER → 2024 Prelims General Studies Paper I, question numbered 100 DEMAND → the unorganised-worker pension route, rendered neutrally in the audited ledger	KEY STATUS → official Set-A key available locally; the answer is not recorded there PACKAGE RULE → no option, key or inferred answer letter is stated anywhere here	COVERAGE → voluntary enrolment, matching contributions; pension after sixty, taught as content YEAR AND PAPER → 2024 Prelims General Studies Paper I, question numbered 100

CORE CLAIM
- YEAR AND PAPER → 2024 Prelims General Studies Paper I, question numbered 100
- DEMAND → the unorganised-worker pension route, rendered neutrally in the audited ledger

MECHANISM
- KEY STATUS → official Set-A key available locally; the answer is not recorded there
- PACKAGE RULE → no option, key or inferred answer letter is stated anywhere here

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- COVERAGE → voluntary enrolment, matching contributions; pension after sixty, taught as content
- YEAR AND PAPER → 2024 Prelims General Studies Paper I, question numbered 100

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: PACKAGE RULE → no option, key or inferred answer letter is stated anywhere here.

11 REFORM ARCHITECTURE AND ITS COSTS

REFORM ARCHITECTURE AND ITS COSTS · PUBLISH STATUS · PROVISION-SPECIFIC COMMENCEMENT AND SCHEME STATUS MADE READABLE · AUDITABLE FUND · RECEIPTS AND CLAIMS OPEN TO INSPECTION · ASSISTED ENROLMENT · OFFLINE ROUTES SO DIGITAL EXCLUSION IS NOT BENEFIT EXCLUSION · INDEPENDENT GRIEVANCE

PUBLISH STATUS → provision-specific commencement and scheme status made readable → AUDITABLE FUND: receipts and claims open to inspection → ASSISTED ENROLMENT: offline routes so digital exclusion is not benefit exclusion → INDEPENDENT GRIEVANCE: a forum for deactivation and benefit disputes → COSTS → levy incidence, threshold exclusion, privacy exposure, insurance-led narrowness

CORE CLAIM
- PUBLISH STATUS → provision-specific commencement and scheme status made readable
- AUDITABLE FUND: receipts and claims open to inspection

MECHANISM
- ASSISTED ENROLMENT: offline routes so digital exclusion is not benefit exclusion
- INDEPENDENT GRIEVANCE: a forum for deactivation and benefit disputes

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- COSTS → levy incidence, threshold exclusion, privacy exposure, insurance-led narrowness
- EVIDENCE LIMIT: AUTHORITY / IMPLEMENTATION: Use labour codes only with notified/operative…

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: EVIDENCE LIMIT: AUTHORITY / IMPLEMENTATION: Use labour codes only with notified/operative.

E SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

EXTRA · OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT · CODE ON SOCIAL SECURITY, 2020 · ENACTED FRAMEWORK THAT CONTAINS GIG/PLATFORM · DELIVERY INSTITUTIONS · EPFO, ESIC AND STATE BOCW WELFARE BOARDS REMAIN CENTRAL · MOLE NATIONAL DATABASE/UAN INFRASTRUCTURE; USEFUL FOR MAPPING AND · VOLUNTARY CONTRIBUTORY PENSION ROUTE FOR ELIGIBLE UNORGANISED WORKERS · RECOMMENDED DESIGN

OPTIONAL SOURCE DEPTH
- Code on Social Security, 2020: enacted framework that contains gig/platform
- Delivery institutions: EPFO, ESIC and State BOCW Welfare Boards remain central
- e-Shram: MoLE national database/UAN infrastructure; useful for mapping and
- PM-SYM: voluntary contributory pension route for eligible unorganised workers;

ADVANCED DEBATE
- CAUTION: Recommended design: publish provision-specific commencement and scheme status,
- CAUTION: A rider engaged through two platforms may satisfy the Code definitions but still
- CAUTION: A BOCW-registered migrant construction worker may receive a State-board benefit,
- CAUTION: A platform calling a worker a "partner" may not defeat a future social-security

LEGACY / NUANCE
- CAUTION: Contribution incidence: An aggregator levy can finance protection but may be
- CAUTION: Threshold design: Any work-day/earnings threshold could simplify administration
- CAUTION: Data minimisation: Cross-platform portability improves protection but creates
- CAUTION: Insurance-led bias: Hospitalisation or accident cover alone cannot correct

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.

END OF MASTER CANVAS • poster embeds this exact master • tiled pages are overlapping crops of the same pixels